Reporting eight seasons of product design, teams built, and systems shipped

ANIMISH KOLGE

DESIGN LEADER · AI & AR/VR/XR PRODUCTS · DESIGN SYSTEMS & OPERATIONS

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✦ HEADLINES · PROFILE

By the Numbers

Results, not adjectives.

8+	YEARS SHIPPING PRODUCT
9	DESIGNERS LED
0→1	DESIGN ORGS BUILT
20K	SAATHI TXNS/DAY · 4× GROWTH
+12%	DAILY BOOKING LIFT
7K	TENO SCHOOLS · +40%

✦ PROVEN ON THE JOB ✦

The Toolkit

LEADERSHIP
Design leadership · Design Ops & governance · 0→1 product design · Team scaling · Hiring & performance · Product strategy · Roadmap ownership · Executive stakeholders · OKRs

UX & RESEARCH
User flows · Information architecture · System design · Conversational & AI UX · Cross-platform design · Growth design · Journey mapping · Task analysis

AI & EMERGING TECH
AI-driven design workflows · Design systems at scale · Prompt engineering (Claude skills) · AR/VR/XR & wearables

TOOLS
Figma · Design handover & audit · Prototyping · Agile / Lean UX

LEAD STORY

Profile

DESIGN LEADERSHIP · PRODUCT STRATEGY · AI · AR/VR/XR

Design leader with 8+ years building consumer products and smart AI glasses, taking products from 0 to 1, scaling design teams, and driving product strategy with executive stakeholders across Fintech, AI, and AR/VR/XR. I set up design functions where none exist: the team, design ops, processes, and governance, while staying close to the product. Currently leading design for AI-powered smart glasses (B by Lenskart) at AjnaLens, including the cross-platform companion app built with Lenskart, and running the company's AI-driven design system.

"From 0 to 1": building the team, the system, and the practice around the work.

✦ LEAD STORY · THE CURRENT POST

Design Lead

AJNALENS · MUMBAI · APR 2025 TO PRESENT

- Lead design for **AI-powered smart glasses** (**B by Lenskart**), among India's first; own the companion app experience (built with Lenskart) and defined the interaction model and production UI for the cross-platform wearable.
- Designed the **AI conversation experience** from the ground up: interaction patterns, responses, and error handling, plus the system design behind it.
- Built and scaled the **design organisation to a 9-member team**; own hiring, mentorship, and performance management across four product lines.
- Kept the team lean; absorbed a workload that would normally need two more junior designers, through better work planning and AI, and manage AI token usage for maximum output at minimum cost.
- Built the design team's first **KRA/KPI framework** (aligned to company OKRs), tied to product goals and career growth; took ownership of the design roadmap.
- Set up the company's first design process and governance: documented standards, a design operations model, and a design maturity model with regular audits, cutting handoff friction and rework.
- Built AI-driven design workflows with custom **Claude skills** for handover, UX flows from PRDs, automated audits, and prompt-to-UI from the component library.

At a Glance

ROLE	Design Lead, AjnaLens
FOCUS	AI wearables · Fintech · Design systems
EXP.	8+ years across product design
BASED	Mumbai, India
OPEN TO	Manager · Principal · Head of Design · Director

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✦ CONTINUED ONLINE ✦

Read the Full Story

VIEW MY PORTFOLIO →

animish93kolge.github.io/Portfolio

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Animish Kolge

✦ CAREER CHRONICLE · THE BACK CATALOGUE

Design Manager

PAYNEARBY · MUMBAI · MAR 2023 TO MAR 2025

- Ran the UX & Design team, keeping product designers and UI developers aligned on user and business goals.
- Owned the UX architecture for flagship products: **Lending & Credit, NeoDukan, and Saathi**, from concept to release.
- Drove product-led growth in Saathi by introducing UPI payments, growing daily transactions from ~**5,000 to 20,000**.
- Led growth design on booking and lending flows: daily train and flight bookings rose **12%**; the gold-loan and mutual-fund journey dropped from **18 steps to 12**.

Lead Experience Designer

PROPELLUM INFOTECH · MUMBAI · OCT 2019 TO MAR 2023

- Managed a team of designers across **Teno, Ulearn, and Practix**, owning design and UX for all three products.
- On Teno, reworked existing features and shipped new ones that helped grow adoption from **5,000 to 7,000 schools** over two years.
- Created and rolled out a design system, standardising UI so the products felt consistent and the team worked faster.

Lead Experience Designer

INFOSYS DIGITAL · BANGALORE · JUL 2018 TO OCT 2019

- Delivered design across financial and Sanofi projects, including an **AR training experience** for Sanofi.
- Helped set up and lead the Infosys Design Studio, laying the groundwork for design practice there.

Design Intern

SCHBANG · MUMBAI · DEC 2017 TO JUL 2018

- Designed UI for web and mobile and built interactive prototypes, working with researchers on concept and usability testing.

✦ THE TOOLKIT · FULL DIRECTORY

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TOOLS
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✦ CREDENTIALS

M.DES, GRAPHIC DESIGN
MIT Institute of Design · 2016 to 2018

B.SC. INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY
Mumbai University · 2013 to 2016

HUMAN-COMPUTER INTERACTION
IIT Bombay · 2022

INTRODUCTION TO MIXED REALITY
Microsoft Learning Challenge · 2024

UX & INTERACTION DESIGN, AR/VR/MR/XR
Coursera · In progress

VISITING UX FACULTY
Edit Institute · mentoring & workshops

Editor's Note

Available for Design Manager, Principal, Head of Design and Design Director roles. Enquiries welcome at the Contact Desk.

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Contact Desk

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✦ ADVERTISEMENT ✦

Now Taking Enquiries for the *Next Season*

DESIGN MANAGER · PRINCIPAL · HEAD OF DESIGN · DESIGN DIRECTOR

✦

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